



Edwin Giltay <edwingiltay@gmail.com>

RE: Concerns about Dutch candidate for European Ombudsman

1 bericht

VISTISEN Anders <anders.vistisen@europarl.europa.eu>

10 december 2024 om 09:59

Aan: Edwin Giltay <edwingiltay@gmail.com>

Cc: [REDACTED]

Dear Mr. Giltay

Thank you for your message and for sharing your experiences and perspective on this matter.

I understand that issues of transparency and integrity are crucial, especially when it comes to a role like the European Ombudsman.

As a group, we have decided not to support Reinier van Zutphen as a candidate. This decision has been made in line with our principles and also aligns with the position of our Dutch delegation within the group.

We place a high priority on transparency and credibility, and it is essential that the European Ombudsman enjoys broad trust.

Thank you once again for taking the time to write and for sharing your book. I truly appreciate your dedication to this issue.

Best regards,

**Anders Vistisen**

Chief whip | Patriots for Europe

Member of the European Parliament

[LinkedIn](#) | [Facebook](#) | [Instagram](#) | [X](#) | [Threads](#)**From:** Edwin Giltay <edwingiltay@gmail.com>**Sent:** 09 December 2024 19:09**To:** VISTISEN Anders <anders.vistisen@europarl.europa.eu>**Subject:** Concerns about Dutch candidate for European Ombudsman

Dear Mr. Anders Vistisen,

As a Dutch writer, I feel it is important to raise critical concerns regarding Mr. Reinier van Zutphen, one of the candidates for European Ombudsman. Last week in Brussels, he stressed his commitment to transparency and 'speaking truth to power'. However, based on my personal experiences and his record as National Ombudsman of the Netherlands, I have seen instances where his actions did not align with these words.

During his time as Ombudsman, Mr. Van Zutphen has not consistently addressed government abuses and in several instances has obstructed transparency. Two specific examples show my concerns:

Srebrenica: After witnessing a military intelligence affair linked to the Dutch role in Srebrenica, I was discredited in an official report by the National Ombudsman at the time. In response, I wrote *The Cover-up General* to bring the facts to light. Following a temporary ban, the [Court of Appeal in The Hague](#) reviewed and confirmed the accuracy of my book, effectively invalidating the Ombudsman's report. Despite this court ruling, Mr. Van Zutphen has not retracted or corrected the report.

Transparency: In recent lawsuits I won, Mr. Van Zutphen was found guilty of [unlawful conduct](#) and had to pay me a fine for obstructing transparency.

These examples raise serious questions about his suitability for the role of European Ombudsman. Integrity, credibility, and public trust are essential for this role — qualities that, based on my experience, have not always been demonstrated by Mr. Van Zutphen, particularly in ensuring transparency and international accountability in sensitive governmental matters.

I encourage you to carefully consider these issues before voting on 17 December. I have enclosed the English edition of my book, *The Cover-up General*, which has been endorsed by numerous experts. Additional context and supporting evidence are available at thecoverupgeneral.com.

Thank you for your attention to this matter. Please contact me if you have any questions or need more information.

Yours sincerely,
Edwin Giltay



The Cover-up General.pdf

6470K